LEARN 2 LIVE LEGACY

PRESENTS

THE FORGIVENESS FRAMEWORK

A THEATRE-LED CULTURAL & YOUTH ENGAGEMENT MODEL

CREATING SPACES WHERE YOUNG PEOPLE, COMMUNITIES AND CULTURE COME TOGETHER TO EXPLORE FORGIVENESS, RESPONSIBILITY AND THE CHOICES THAT SHAPE OUR LIVES.

DEVELOPED IN BRIXTON. DESIGNED FOR BOROUGH DELIVERY.

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1. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The Forgiveness Framework is a theatre-led civic model that connects professional performance, youth voice development and structured dialogue to support young people and communities in processing conflict, identity and lived experience.

Across educational and community settings, responses to youth violence and behavioural challenges are often reactive or punitive. While these approaches may address immediate incidents, they rarely create space for reflection, accountability or long-term behavioural change. At the same time, young people are navigating increasingly complex social environments in which exposure to conflict, online influence and unresolved experiences can shape decision-making.

The Framework introduces a structured, engagement-led approach that creates space for reflection rather than suppression. It combines live theatre, facilitated dialogue and creative participation to enable young people to explore consequence, responsibility and future choice within a supported environment.

Forgiveness, within this model, is not presented as a moral instruction or religious obligation. It is positioned as a practical human framework grounded in the reality that we cannot change what has already happened to us and that retaliation, however instinctive, does not undo harm or restore loss. Forgiveness, by contrast, is the decision to move forward without reproducing the harm experienced. Understood and delivered within the context of this framework, forgiveness becomes a tool for breaking cycles of retaliation, supporting accountability and enabling forward-focused thinking.

The programme is anchored by the professional staging of Our Son, creating a shared cultural experience through which audiences engage with themes of identity, consequence and forgiveness. Together, these elements create a structured cultural experience where theatre becomes the catalyst for youth voice, reflection and civic dialogue.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Elements of this approach have already been delivered through Learn 2 Live Legacy in partnership with organisations including the Kiyan Prince Foundation, Saint Gabriel's College and Final Call Productions. These events combined theatre, spoken word and public dialogue, demonstrating strong engagement and a clear demand for spaces where difficult themes can be explored honestly and constructively.

The Framework is led by Jermaine Wong, founder of Learn 2 Live Legacy, whose work sits at the intersection of education, theatre and lived experience. The philosophy underpinning the model was not developed in theory but tested in reality following the murder of his son in Brixton. The decision to reject retaliation and uphold forgiveness did not remove the loss, but it established a different way forward. That experience, combined with nearly three decades of work in education and youth engagement, has been translated into a structured model designed to support others in navigating similar tensions.

The proposed Theatre Space development represents the next stage of a borough-level implementation connecting professional theatre, educational engagement, youth creative development and civic dialogue within a single, coherent model.

The Framework is built on a simple but critical premise: we cannot change the past, but we can influence what happens next.

2. PILOT OVERVIEW

Venue: Borough Arts Venues (i.e Brixton House)

Artistic Anchor: Professional staging of Our Son

Participants: Young people from participating educational settings

Programme Structure:
- Theatre Encounter
- Youth Voice Development
- Creative Response
- Civic Youth Voices Showcase

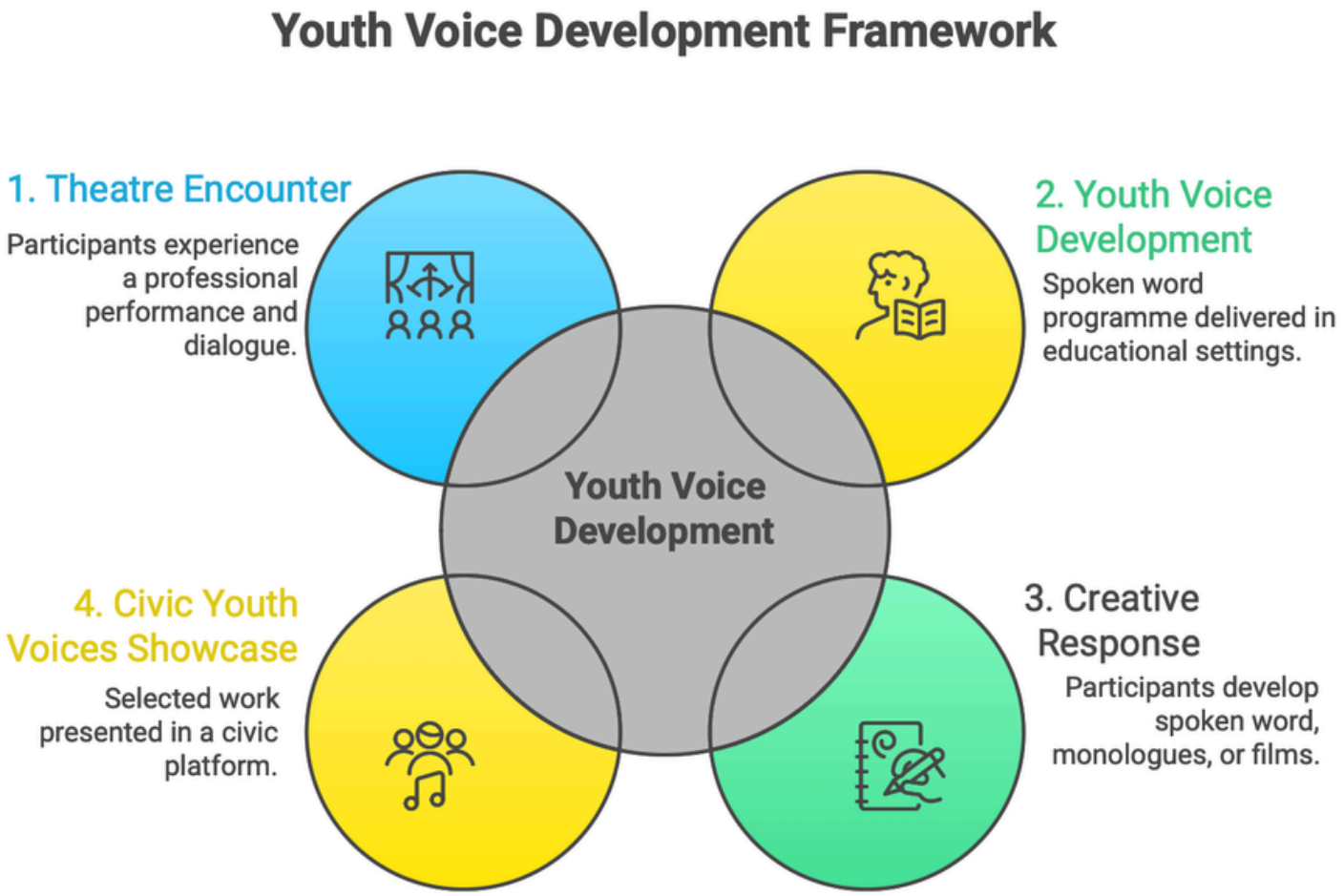
Public Engagement:
- Theatre audiences
- Writer/Director dialogue
- Civic Youth Voices event

Outcome:
A theatre-led civic initiative connecting artistic storytelling with youth voice, creative participation and community dialogue.

3. PROGRAMME STRUCTURE

The Forgiveness Framework is delivered through a clear sequence of engagement stages that connect artistic experience with youth voice and reflection.

Educational partners may also engage through introductory assemblies or keynote sessions, providing an accessible entry point into the programme and a pathway into deeper participation.



4. THE ARTISTIC ANCHOR - OUR SON

The initiative is anchored by the professional presentation of Our Son, a one-act drama exploring fatherhood, identity, pride and forgiveness.

The play provides a shared artistic experience through which audiences engage with themes that resonate across generations and communities. Each performance is followed by a moderated Writer/Director dialogue, ensuring that the artistic experience becomes the starting point for structured reflection and civic conversation.

5. CULTURAL PARTNERSHIP

The presentation of Our Son at a Borough Arts Venue like Brixton House forms part of a wider civic cultural moment connecting theatre, youth voice and community dialogue.

As leading cultural institutions within the local areas, the venues provide a setting that reflects the lived experiences informing the philosophy of the Framework. Presenting the work within this context situates the initiative not only as a performance, but as a contribution to a broader civic conversation rooted in place.

The partnership positions these Borough Arts Venues not only as a venue, but as a cultural anchor for a wider civic initiative connecting theatre, youth voice and dialogue.

6. FINANCIAL FRAMEWORK

The Forgiveness Framework pilot is structured as a co-funded, partially self-sustaining model.

Project Costs

Category	Cost
Theatre Hire (2 weeks)	£16,313
Actor Fees	£8,900
Creative Direction (Writer/Director)	£6,000
Framework Facilitation & Delivery	£4,000
Production & Technical	£8,000
Marketing & Communications	£5,000
Educational Programme Delivery	£7,500
Project Management	£5,000
Evaluation & Documentation	£2,500

Total Project Cost: £63,213

Projected Income

Source Amount
Ticket Sales (Sell-out projection)
£54,883

Funding Gap: ~£8,300

Investment is positioned to support access, educational delivery and programme depth, rather than core viability.

7. PROGRAMME DELIVERY, IMPACT & OUTCOME

The Framework builds on delivery already undertaken through Learn 2 Live Legacy events centred around Our Son.

These events demonstrated:

- strong audience engagement (with audiences of over 120+ per event)
- sustained participation in post-show dialogue (with over 70% of attendees remaining for facilitated discussion)
- a clear willingness among young people to explore complex and sensitive themes

KEY INSIGHTS FROM DELIVERY

Through this work, several important insights have emerged that directly inform the design of the Framework:

1. Theatre creates emotional access where traditional interventions cannot

Live performance enables audiences, particularly young people, to engage with difficult themes indirectly, reducing defensiveness and increasing openness to reflection.

2. Young people are willing to engage deeply when given the right environment

When spaces are intentionally held and facilitated, young people demonstrate a strong capacity to discuss complex issues such as loss, identity, accountability and forgiveness.

3. There is a clear demand for structured spaces to process lived experience

Both young people and educators responded positively to environments that allowed honest exploration of real-life challenges, highlighting a gap in existing provision.

The Borough Arts Venue development will track:

- participation levels
- engagement with theatre attendance
- student confidence indicators
- creative output development
- teacher and facilitator feedback

Evaluation methods include:

- pre- and post-programme surveys
- facilitator observation
- creative output documentation

8. SAFEGUARDING & ETHICAL DELIVERY

All youth engagement activity will be delivered in collaboration with participating educational institutions and in alignment with their safeguarding frameworks.

Student wellbeing and respectful participation remain central to the design and delivery of all activities.

Risk	Mitigation
Scheduling conflicts	Early coordination with partner institutions
Emotional sensitivity	Moderated discussions and safeguarding support
Behavioural challenges	Structured supervision
Funding variability	Blended funding model
Implementation scope	Pilot-scale delivery

9. PARTNERSHIPS

Previous delivery has included partnership with the Kiyan Prince Foundation, Saint Gabriel's College and Final Call Productions combining theatre and dialogue around forgiveness and youth violence.

Potential partners may include:

- educational institutions
- theatre venues
- youth organisations
- local authorities

The Framework is designed as a structured model rather than a personality-led programme. While the pilot phase will initially be facilitated by the founder of Learn 2 Live Legacy, the methodology is intended to be documented and delivered collaboratively with trained facilitators and partner organisations.

Saint Gabriel's College will serve as an early educational partner, having agreed in principle to host the Learn 2 Live Legacy Spoken Word Programme, providing an important early educational environment through which elements of the Forgiveness Framework can be explored and refined as the model develops.

This partnership provides an opportunity to pilot the Framework's youth engagement stages within a real educational context while remaining open to collaboration with additional educational institutions as the initiative grows.

10. FUTURE SCALABILITY

As the Framework develops, opportunities may emerge for cross-borough collaborations, shared youth voice platforms and expanded theatre-led civic dialogue initiatives connecting multiple cultural venues and educational institutions.

Evaluation findings from the development phase will inform future development.

11. PHILOSOPHICAL FOUNDATION

The philosophy underpinning the Framework was shaped through lived experience following the murder of Jermaine Wong's son in Brixton.

The decision to uphold forgiveness did not remove the loss, but it established a different way forward. The Framework translates that experience into a structured cultural model that enables young people and communities to explore identity, conflict and future possibility through theatre and dialogue.

12. NEXT STEPS & OPPORTUNITY

Potential next steps include:

- Confirming borough partnership
- identifying participating educational institutions
- securing venue availability
- aligning co-funding partners
- scheduling pilot delivery

The Forgiveness Framework is not designed as a one-off intervention, but as a model that can be embedded across boroughs, connecting theatre, education and community in a shared process of reflection and forward movement.

At its core, this work is grounded in a simple reality: we cannot change what has already happened.

But we can decide whether we continue cycles of harm, or begin to interrupt them.

The opportunity now is to establish a model that gives young people and communities the space, structure and support to move forward differently — not by ignoring the past, but by choosing what comes next.

Jermaine Wong
Founder
Learn 2 Live Legacy